

go-mdtopdf-helper

A command-line tool that automatically converts Markdown files to PDF. Perfect for maintaining PDF documentation alongside your Markdown files in Git repositories.

Features

- Converts Markdown files to PDF with a choice of rendering engines
- Works out of the box: the default engine is pure Go with no external dependencies
- Can run as a Git pre-commit hook
- Recursive directory scanning
- Parallel file processing
- Cross-platform support (Windows, Linux, macOS)

Engines

Select an engine with `-engine:`

Engine	Needs	Notes
gopdf (default)	nothing	Pure Go. Supports headings, paragraphs, bold/italic/code, links, lists, code blocks, quotes, rules and tables. Images are shown as <code>[image: alt]</code> .
chromedp	Chrome or Chromium	Best rendering (full HTML/CSS). Runs headless Chrome; the sandbox is disabled automatically when running as root, as in most CI containers.
wkhtmltopdf	wkhtmltopdf	Legacy engine. Looked up in the standard install locations (Windows: <code>C:\Program Files\wkhtmltopdf\bin</code> , Linux/macOS: <code>/usr/local/bin</code> , <code>/usr/bin</code> , Homebrew).

Installation

```
go get github.com/Warky-Devs/go-mdtopdf-helper
```

Usage

Basic Usage

Convert Markdown files in the current directory:

```
go-mdtopdf-helper
```

Command Line Options

```
go-mdtopdf-helper [options]
```

Options:

```
-dir string
    Directory to scan for markdown files (default ".")
-recursive
    Scan directories recursively (default true)
-parallel
    Convert files in parallel (default true)
-hook
    Run as git pre-commit hook
-engine string
    PDF engine: gopdf, wkhtmltopdf, chromedp (default "gopdf")
```

Git Pre-commit Hook

To use as a Git pre-commit hook:

1. Create a file named `pre-commit` in your repository's `.git/hooks/` directory
2. Add the following content:

```
#!/bin/sh
go-mdtopdf-helper -hook
```

1. Make the hook executable:

```
chmod +x .git/hooks/pre-commit
```

When enabled as a pre-commit hook, the tool will: 1. Detect staged Markdown files 2. Ask for confirmation before conversion 3. Convert files to PDF 4. Automatically stage the generated PDFs

PDF Output Configuration

Generated PDFs are A4 with 15mm margins on all sides. The `chromedp` and `wkhtmltopdf` engines render the full Markdown-to-HTML output, so they support everything the Markdown parser's common extensions produce.

Project Layout

<code>cmd/go-mdtopdf-helper/</code>	CLI entry point (flags, hook mode)
<code>internal/converter/</code>	File discovery, parallel conversion, git hook
<code>internal/engine/</code>	Engine interface and the <code>gopdf</code> , <code>wkhtmltopdf</code> and <code>chromedp</code> backends

Contributing

Contributions are welcome! Please feel free to submit a Pull Request. Here's how you can contribute:

1. Fork the repository
2. Create your feature branch (`git checkout -b feature/AmazingFeature`)

3. Commit your changes (`git commit -m 'Add some AmazingFeature'`)
4. Push to the branch (`git push origin feature/AmazingFeature`)
5. Open a Pull Request

Development Setup

1. Clone the repository
2. Install dependencies:

```
go mod download
```

3. Make your changes
4. Run tests:

```
make test
```

`make` also provides `build`, `lint` (`golangci-lint`), `format` (`gofmt`) and `all`. Tests for the `chromedp` and `wkhtmltopdf` engines are skipped when the tool is not installed.

Dependencies

- [gopdf](#) – Pure Go PDF generation
- [chromedp](#) – Headless Chrome driver
- [go-wkhtmltopdf](#) – Go wrapper for `wkhtmltopdf`
- [gomarkdown](#) – Markdown parser and HTML renderer

License

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Acknowledgments

- Thanks to [SebastiaanKlippert](#) for the `go-wkhtmltopdf` library
- Thanks to the `gomarkdown` team for their Markdown parser